Project Proposal
MIT4301 Independent Study

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1. Project Title
University Student Task Board System

This project is a web-based system for university students to post and find small tasks. A student can use one account to post a task or apply for a task posted by another student. The task poster can view the applicants, select one student and update the task as assigned or completed. An optional reward can be shown, but payments will be handled outside the system.

2. Background and Problem Understanding

University students may need help with small tasks such as designing a poster, helping with an event, taking photographs, doing data entry or providing tutoring. Other students may have the required skills and may be interested in completing these tasks.

These opportunities are often shared through personal contacts, messaging groups or social media. The information can be scattered, and interested students may not see it. It may also be difficult for a task poster to keep track of applicants and the progress of a task. The proposed system will provide one place to post tasks, apply, select an applicant and track each task until completion. Similar job and task platforms use related posting and selection processes (Fiverr International Ltd., n.d.; Taskrabbit, n.d.; Upwork, n.d.).

3. Project Objectives

1. Allow students to register and log in.
2. Allow students to post, edit and delete their own tasks.
3. Allow students to browse, filter and apply for available tasks.
4. Allow task posters to view applications and select one applicant.
5. Track each task as Open, Assigned or Completed.
6. Allow an administrator to manage users and unsuitable task posts.
7. Store user, task and application information in a MySQL database.

4. Proposed System

The main users will be registered students and the system administrator. A registered student can use the same account to post tasks and apply for tasks. A task post will contain a title, description, category, deadline and optional reward. Other students can browse open tasks and submit applications. The task poster can view the applicants, select one student and later mark the task as completed.

The main inputs will be registration details, task details, applications and status updates. The outputs will include the list of available tasks, application details, the selected applicant and the current task status. The administrator will be able to manage users and remove unsuitable posts. All information will be stored in a MySQL database.

5. Project Scope

Included in the project

- Student registration and login.
- Post, edit and delete tasks.
- Browse and filter available tasks.
- Apply, view applications and select one applicant.
- Track Open, Assigned and Completed statuses.
- Display an optional reward and provide basic administrator controls.

Not included in the project

Online payments, live chat, email or SMS notifications, maps, location tracking, ratings, reviews, artificial intelligence features and a mobile application will not be included. This keeps the work suitable for one student and realistic within the available period.

Minimum working version

The minimum version will include registration and login, task posting, task browsing, applications, applicant selection, status updates and MySQL data storage. These functions will form the main target for the final demonstration.

6. Proposed Technologies and Tools

Technology or tool	**Purpose**
HTML and CSS	Create the web pages and their layout.
JavaScript	Add simple interactions and form validation.
PHP	Handle system functions and communicate with the database.
MySQL	Store users, tasks, applications and statuses.
XAMPP	Run PHP and MySQL locally during development.
VS Code	Write and manage the project code.
Git and GitHub	Save versions and show development progress.

PHP and MySQL are suitable because they support forms, user accounts and database operations, and they are recommended for web projects in the module guideline. Official documentation is available for the selected web technologies (MDN contributors, 2025; Oracle Corporation, 2026; PHP Documentation Group, 2026).

7. Proposed Development Approach

1. Requirements analysis: Identify the users, required functions and project limits.
2. Design: Prepare page layouts, the system flow and the database structure.
3. Implementation: Develop the system one function at a time, starting with registration and login.
4. Testing: Test each function and then test the complete workflow.
5. Evaluation: Compare the finished system with the objectives and identify possible improvements.

Git and GitHub will be used throughout the project to keep a record of changes.

8. Expected Deliverables

- A working University Student Task Board web application.
- The complete source code and MySQL database structure.
- A GitHub repository showing the development history.
- Test results for the main functions.
- A portfolio containing the ten weekly chapters and supporting evidence.
- A working version that can be demonstrated during the final viva.

9. Work Plan and Timeline

Weeks	**Planned work**
1-2	Topic selection, feasibility study, background study, requirements and proposal.
3	Page designs, system flow and initial database design.
4-5	Development environment, form validation, repository and database setup.
6	Registration, login and task posting.
7	Task browsing, applications, testing and debugging.
8	Applicant selection, status updates and basic administrator functions.
9-10	System testing, usability improvements, bug fixing and refactoring.
11-12	Final improvements, testing evidence, screenshots and portfolio completion.
13-15	Viva preparation, demonstration and defense.

10. References

Fiverr International Ltd. (n.d.) How Fiverr Works. Available at: https://www.fiverr.com/cp/how-fiverr-works (Accessed: 16 September 2026).

MDN contributors (2025) Learn web development. MDN Web Docs. Available at: https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Learn_web_development (Accessed: 16 September 2026).

Oracle Corporation (2026) MySQL 8.4 Reference Manual. Available at: https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/8.4/en/ (Accessed: 16 September 2026).

PHP Documentation Group (2026) PHP Manual. Available at: https://www.php.net/manual/en/ (Accessed: 16 September 2026).

Taskrabbit (n.d.) How It Works. Available at: https://www.taskrabbit.com/how-it-works (Accessed: 16 September 2026).

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